Part 4 - Workflow or agent?

These are recurring tasks in Search & Recommendations. The choice depends on how predictable the steps are. It does not mean the basic search API needs an AI model at runtime.

Recurring task	Best fit	One-sentence reason
Validate incoming catalog data and refresh the index	Workflow	Fetching, validating and updating follow a known sequence that should run deterministically.
Classify a natural-language request as a product lookup, comparison or recommendation	Routing	Classifying the intent selects the specialised handler for that request.
Generate and check candidate search synonyms	Prompt chaining	Extracting terms, proposing synonyms and checking relevance are dependent stages with inspectable outputs.
Improve a ranking configuration against labelled examples	Evaluator and optimizer	Explicit relevance checks guide bounded revisions to the candidate configuration.
Investigate why an expected product is missing from search	Agent	The investigation must choose its next action based on findings about source data, visibility, filters or indexing.

We selected the pattern that fits each task; the exercise does not require using every lecture pattern. Lecture-specific terminology should be checked against the course material when available.